

RHYTHM-IFY YOUR PATTERNS!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #196

Melodic patterns are a fantastic tool to jump start our solo ideas. Sonny Stitt, Chick Corea and Woody Shaw all used melodic patterns, and so did their all their jazz buddies. You should too. But once we have a great melodic pattern, then what? How do we spice it up, or add a bit of personality to these patterns, as Chick Corea did? The answer: rhythm.

A great place to start is by experimenting with creating groupings of note that flow against the time signature. If we are in 4/4, odd groupings of notes (like 3 or 5) can create a great effect. Just inserting an 8th rest can change everything, and make a simple pattern amazing.

#1 - C major in ascending 3rds



#2 - Inserting a rest to create groupings of three (two measure pattern)



#3 - Inserting a rest to create groupings of three (four measure pattern)



In example #4, we continue to use the same simple pattern of a major scale in 3rds. By using just one 8th rest in the right spot, we can create groupings of 5. When creating these groupings (3 or 5 or 7), it's all about where you put the 8th rest. Melodically, the pattern stays the same.

#4 - Inserting a rest to create groupings of five

